

TidyTuesday Week 40

Pranay Gundam

Friday 2nd October, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the only weekly newsletter brave enough to shove two completely unrelated government spreadsheets into a regression and act surprised by the results. This week the slot machine of FRED coughed up a genuinely eclectic lineup, and I'm pleased to report that chaos remained firmly in charge. As always, the standing reminder: these pairs are chosen at random, nobody is claiming anybody causes anybody, and if you find yourself nodding along to any of the "theories" below, please go outside.

Monday kicked things off with Great Lakes wood product manufacturing GDP versus mobile cellular subscriptions across Europe and Central Asia, a pairing so natural it barely needs explaining. The raw regression shrugged – nothing significant, a pathetic R-squared, and a p-value that wandered off to get a coffee. But then, plot twist nobody asked for: the detrended version actually turned up significant, with Midwestern lumber output mildly and negatively linked to how many phones Kazakhstan has. This is the rare, slightly unsettling case where the relationship survives the trend-stripping gauntlet, which technically makes it "better evidence of a genuine link." I will let you sit with the implications of Michigan plywood haunting Eurasian cell plans. I certainly won't be.

Tuesday delivered the week's headline act: a discontinued 1929-to-2011 measure of wage-and-salary share of national income against the number of Black or African American persons not in the labor force, and WOW did the raw regression light up like a slot machine jackpot – R-squared of 0.89, a p-value with twenty zeros, the works. Hold the parade, though, because this is the exact trend-mirage this project exists to mock: two long series both marching in the same direction over decades will "correlate" beautifully for no reason at all. The detrended version promptly dropped the R-squared to a modest 0.23. Still technically significant, sure, but it went from "soulmates" to "acquaintances who occasionally wave," which is roughly the demotion every raw hit deserves.

Wednesday paired imports of intellectual-property service charges with the durable-goods share of consumption, and it ran the identical playbook: shiny significant raw result, R-squared of 0.32, dazzling p-value – followed by a detrended R-squared of 0.02 and a p-value of 0.44, i.e., the statistical equivalent of a shrug and a long silence. Textbook mirage. Thursday then gave us government imputed receipts versus discontinued U.S. official reserve assets, which had the decency to be boring in both versions – nothing significant anywhere, a refreshing palate cleanser of pure noise. And Friday closed with the Producer Price Index for Computer Training Services against domestic finance company securities flows, which flopped in the raw regression but flirted with significance once detrended (p around 0.07, for the thrill-seekers). So another

week in the books: one legitimately intriguing survivor, two gloriously debunked trend-illusions, and a comforting reminder that if you torture enough random data pairs, a few will eventually confess to anything. None of it means a thing, and that's the whole point.

2 Date: 2026-09-28

Series ID: GLAKWPMANRGSP

This series is titled Real Gross Domestic Product: Wood Product Manufacturing (321) in the Great Lakes BEA Region and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Millions of Chained 2017 Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1997-01-01 and the observation end date is 2024-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: ITCELSETSP2ECS

This series is titled Mobile Cellular Subscriptions: All Income Levels in Europe and Central Asia and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Number per 100 People and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1960-01-01 and the observation end date is 2025-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ITCELSETSP2ECS	R-squared:	0.083
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.048
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	2.357
Date:	Mon, 28 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.137
Time:	18:50:21	Log-Likelihood:	-142.11
No. Observations:	28	AIC:	288.2
Df Residuals:	26	BIC:	290.9
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	285.3207	123.888	2.303	0.030	30.665	539.976
value_fred_GLAKWPMANRGSP	-0.0407	0.026	-1.535	0.137	-0.095	0.014

Omnibus:	3.492	Durbin-Watson:	0.174
Prob(Omnibus):	0.174	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.983
Skew:	-0.713	Prob(JB):	0.225
Kurtosis:	2.275	Cond. No.	7.63e+04

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 7.63e+04. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

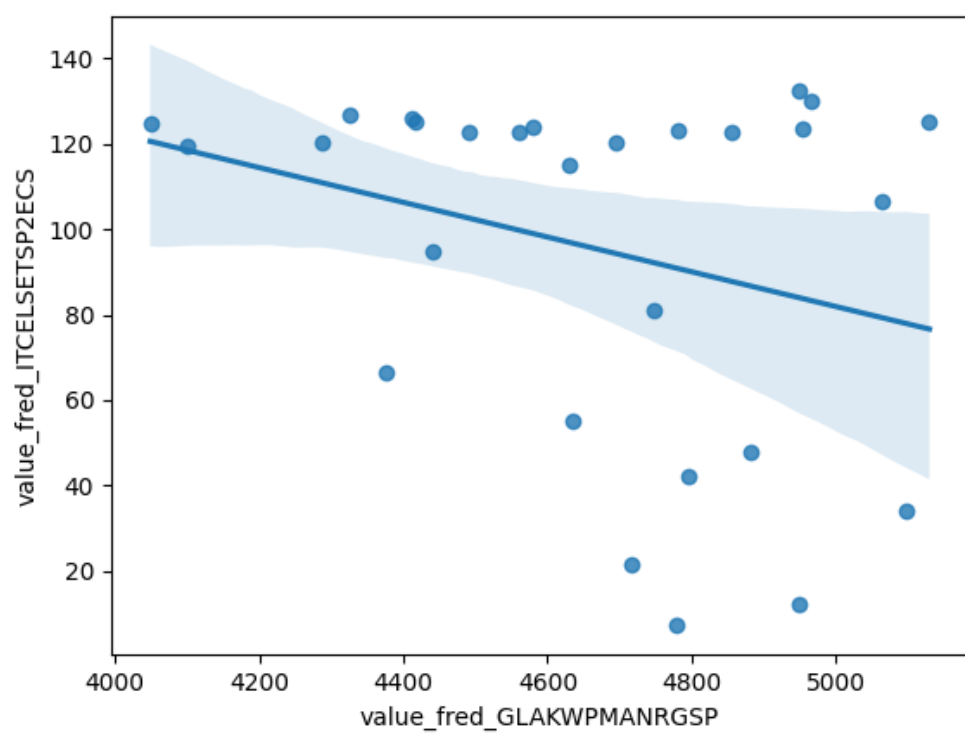


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-28

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ITCELSETSP2ECS_detrended	R-squared:	0.184
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.152
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	5.853
Date:	Mon, 28 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0228
Time:	18:50:21	Log-Likelihood:	-119.03
No. Observations:	28	AIC:	242.1
Df Residuals:	26	BIC:	244.7
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.116e-12	3.330	3.35e-13	1.000	-6.845	6.845
value_fred_GLAKWPMANRGSP_detrended	-0.0283	0.012	-2.419	0.023	-0.052	-0.004

Omnibus:	0.861	Durbin-Watson:	0.444
Prob(Omnibus):	0.650	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.837
Skew:	0.216	Prob(JB):	0.658
Kurtosis:	2.272	Cond. No.	285.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

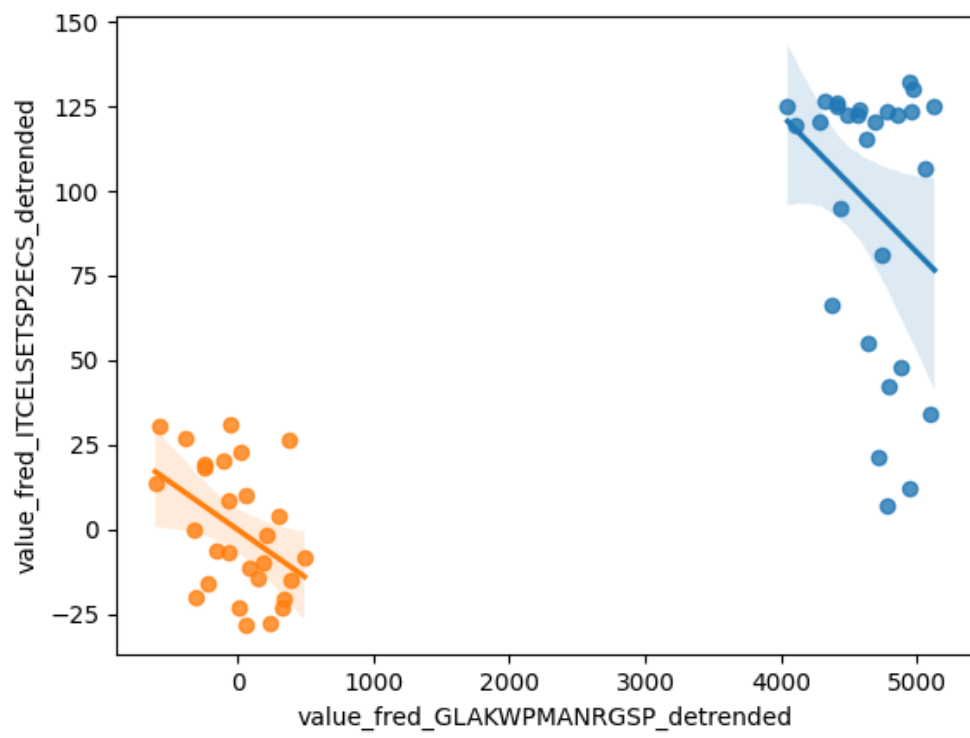


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-28

3 Date: 2026-09-29

Series ID: W269RE1A156NBEA

This series is titled Shares of gross domestic income: Compensation of employees, paid: Wage and salary accruals: Disbursements (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1929-01-01 and the observation end date is 2011-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: LNU05000006

This series is titled Not in Labor Force, Black or African American and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Thousands of Persons and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1972-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-08-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_LNU05000006	R-squared:	0.886			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.883			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	295.5			
Date:	Tue, 29 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	1.63e-19			
Time:	17:07:32	Log-Likelihood:	-300.21			
No. Observations:	40	AIC:	604.4			
Df Residuals:	38	BIC:	607.8			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t 	[0.025	0.975]
const	3.833e+04	1754.440	21.850	0.000	3.48e+04	4.19e+04
value_fred_W269RE1A156NBEA	-632.0219	36.768	-17.190	0.000	-706.454	-557.590
Omnibus:	2.321	Durbin-Watson:	0.414			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.313	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.433			
Skew:	0.178	Prob(JB):	0.488			
Kurtosis:	2.143	Cond. No.	1.17e+03			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.17e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

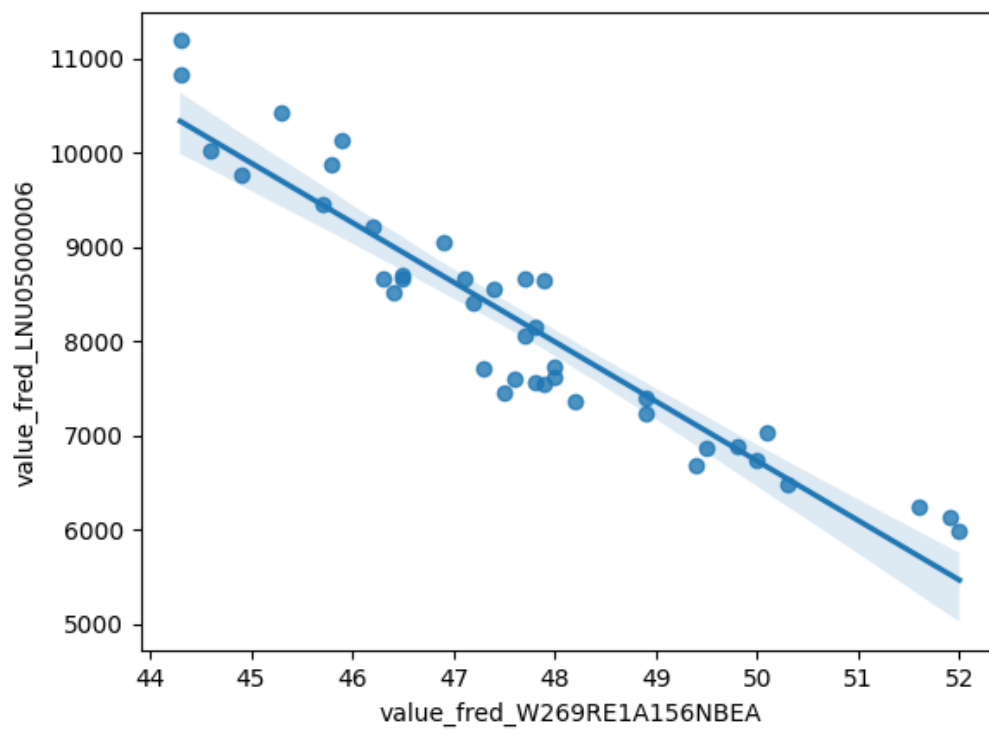


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-29

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_LNU05000006_detrended	R-squared:	0.229
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.209
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	11.29
Date:	Tue, 29 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00178
Time:	17:07:32	Log-Likelihood:	-275.80
No. Observations:	40	AIC:	555.6
Df Residuals:	38	BIC:	559.0
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	4.404e-11	38.755	1.14e-12	1.000	-78.455	78.455
value_fred_W269RE1A156NBEA_detrended	-174.7065	51.991	-3.360	0.002	-279.957	-69.456

Omnibus:	8.056	Durbin-Watson:	0.312
Prob(Omnibus):	0.018	Jarque-Bera (JB):	6.850
Skew:	0.862	Prob(JB):	0.0325
Kurtosis:	4.067	Cond. No.	1.34

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

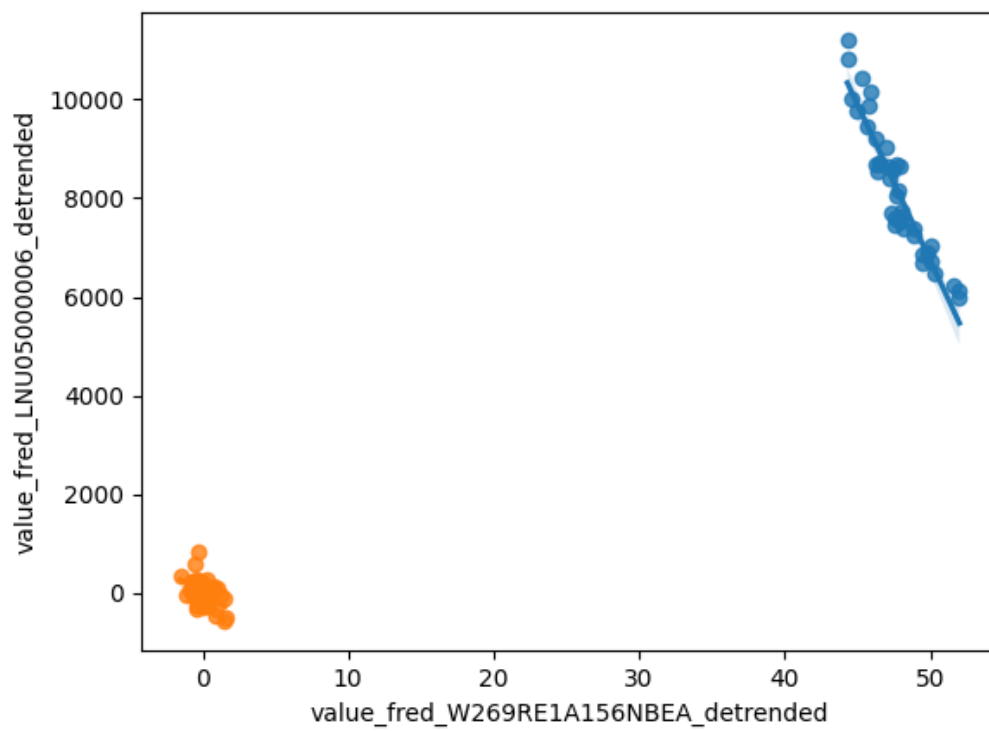


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-29

4 Date: 2026-09-30

Series ID: IEAMSIPN

This series is titled Imports of Services: Charges for the use of intellectual property n.i.e. and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1999-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: DDURRE1A156NBEA

This series is titled Shares of gross domestic product: Personal consumption expenditures: Durable goods and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1929-01-01 and the observation end date is 2025-01-01. The popularity of this series is 4.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_DDURRE1A156NBEA	R-squared:	0.321
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.294
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	11.82
Date:	Wed, 30 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00206
Time:	17:05:45	Log-Likelihood:	-25.239
No. Observations:	27	AIC:	54.48
Df Residuals:	25	BIC:	57.07
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	8.7930	0.314	28.002	0.000	8.146	9.440
value_fred_IEAMSIPN	-0.0001	3.39e-05	-3.438	0.002	-0.000	-4.67e-05

Omnibus:	5.919	Durbin-Watson:	0.272
Prob(Omnibus):	0.052	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.819
Skew:	0.005	Prob(JB):	0.403
Kurtosis:	1.729	Cond. No.	2.36e+04

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.36e+04. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

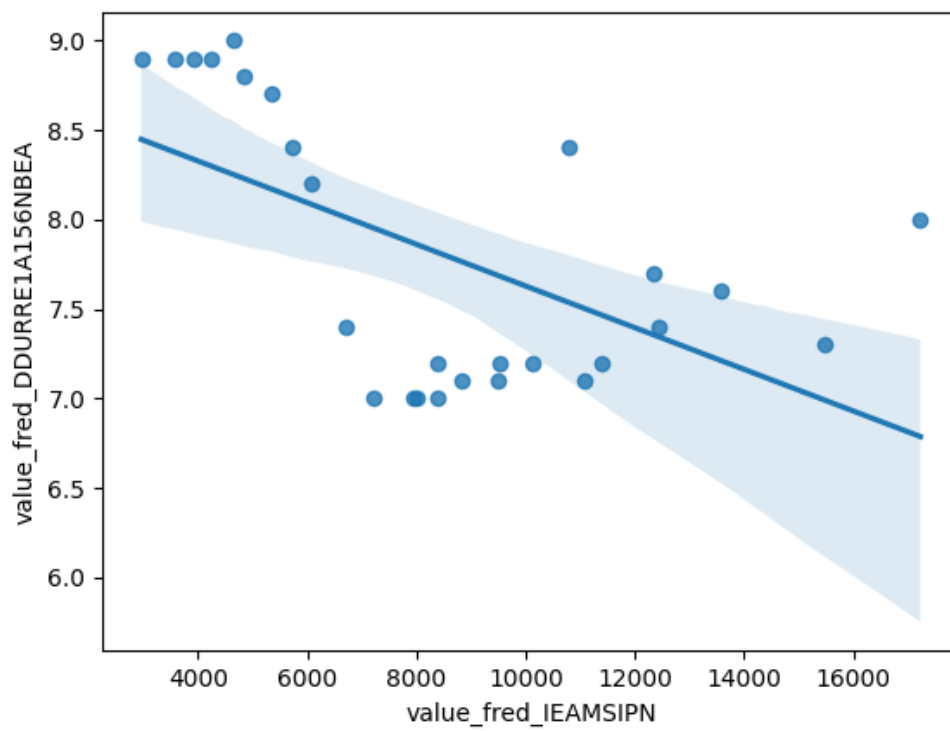


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-30

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_DDURRE1A156NBEA_detrended	R-squared:	0.024
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.015
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.6106
Date:	Wed, 30 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.442
Time:	17:05:45	Log-Likelihood:	-23.256
No. Observations:	27	AIC:	50.51
Df Residuals:	25	BIC:	53.10
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	6.162e-14	0.115	5.38e-13	1.000	-0.236	0.236
value_fred_IEAMSIPN_detrended	8.159e-05	0.000	0.781	0.442	-0.000	0.000

Omnibus:	0.623	Durbin-Watson:	0.358
Prob(Omnibus):	0.732	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.652
Skew:	-0.067	Prob(JB):	0.722
Kurtosis:	2.250	Cond. No.	1.10e+03

Notes:

- [1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
- [2] The condition number is large, 1.1e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

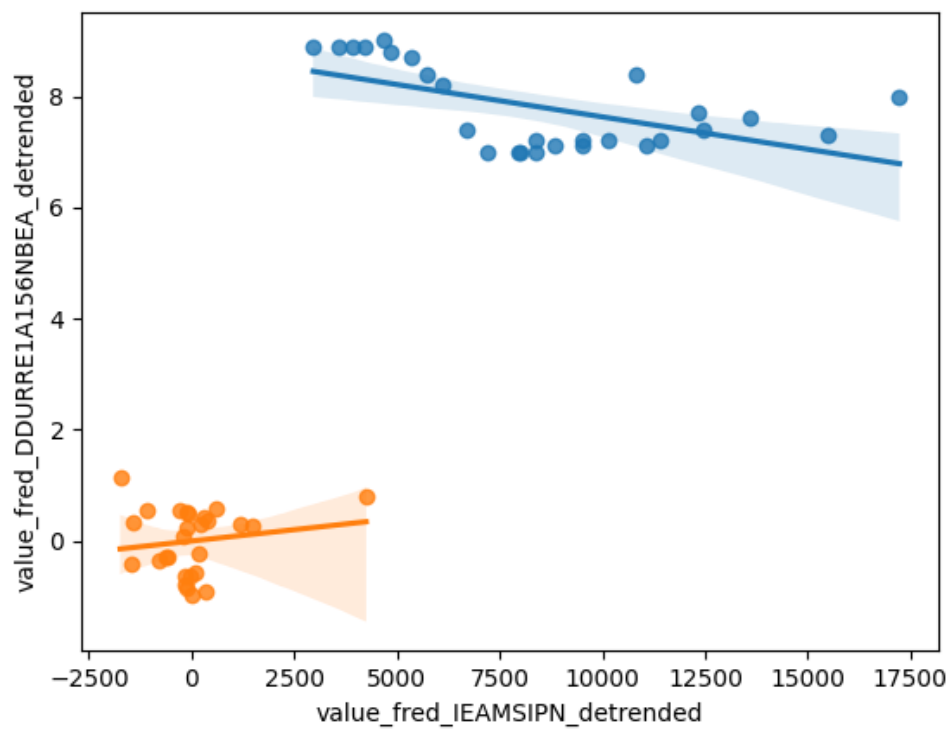


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-30

5 Date: 2026-10-01

Series ID: W568RC1A027NBEA

This series is titled Government current receipts: Imputations and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Billions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1929-01-01 and the observation end date is 2022-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: BOPOON

This series is titled U.S. Official Reserve Assets Abroad, Net (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Billions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1960-01-01 and the observation end date is 2014-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

5.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BOPOON	R-squared:	0.001
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.018
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.04727
Date:	Thu, 01 Oct 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.829
Time:	19:55:13	Log-Likelihood:	-112.57
No. Observations:	55	AIC:	229.1
Df Residuals:	53	BIC:	233.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-0.2012	0.458	-0.439	0.662	-1.119	0.717
value_fred_W568RC1A027NBEA	-0.0115	0.053	-0.217	0.829	-0.117	0.094

Omnibus:	6.566	Durbin-Watson:	1.473
Prob(Omnibus):	0.038	Jarque-Bera (JB):	10.848
Skew:	0.067	Prob(JB):	0.00441
Kurtosis:	5.172	Cond. No.	15.6

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

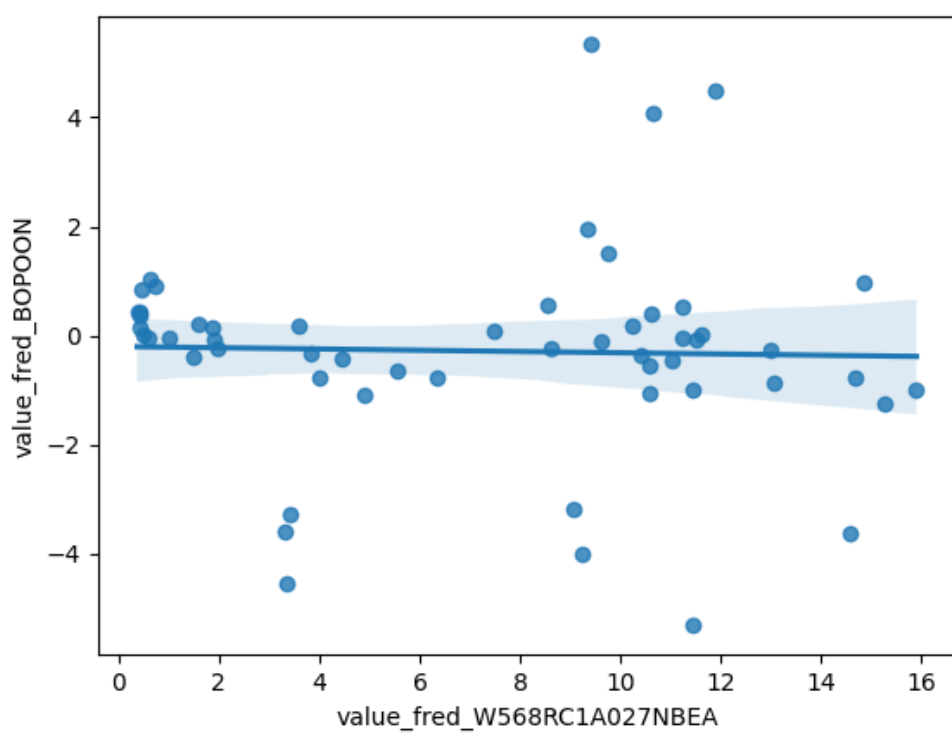


Figure 7: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-01

5.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BOPOON_detrended	R-squared:	0.007
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.011
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.3913
Date:	Thu, 01 Oct 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.534
Time:	19:55:13	Log-Likelihood:	-112.39
No. Observations:	55	AIC:	228.8
Df Residuals:	53	BIC:	232.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.084e-14	0.256	-4.22e-14	1.000	-0.514	0.514
value_fred_W568RC1A027NBEA_detrended	-0.1030	0.165	-0.626	0.534	-0.433	0.227

Omnibus:	5.994	Durbin-Watson:	1.499
Prob(Omnibus):	0.050	Jarque-Bera (JB):	9.174
Skew:	0.019	Prob(JB):	0.0102
Kurtosis:	5.000	Cond. No.	1.56

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

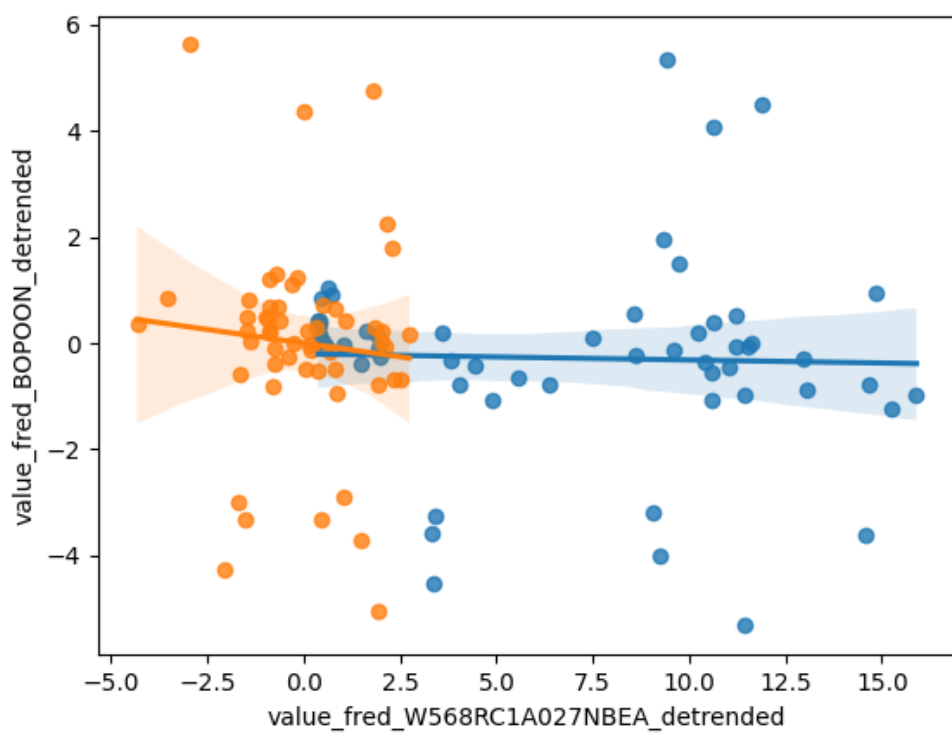


Figure 8: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-01

6 Date: 2026-10-02

Series ID: PCU6114206114201

This series is titled Producer Price Index by Industry: Computer Training: Computer Training Services and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Jun 2006=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2006-06-01 and the observation end date is 2017-08-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: STFAFSXDFBANQ

This series is titled Domestic Finance Companies, Securities, Flow and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Millions of Dollars, Quarterly Rate and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2011-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

6.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_STFAFSXDFBANQ	R-squared:	0.019
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.020
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.4905
Date:	Fri, 02 Oct 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.490
Time:	16:53:47	Log-Likelihood:	-262.34
No. Observations:	27	AIC:	528.7
Df Residuals:	25	BIC:	531.3
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	2.662e+04	3.85e+04	0.691	0.496	-5.28e+04	1.06e+05
value_fred_PCU6114206114201	-233.6407	333.610	-0.700	0.490	-920.724	453.443

Omnibus:	10.482	Durbin-Watson:	1.690
Prob(Omnibus):	0.005	Jarque-Bera (JB):	9.849
Skew:	1.008	Prob(JB):	0.00726
Kurtosis:	5.166	Cond. No.	5.55e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 5.55e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

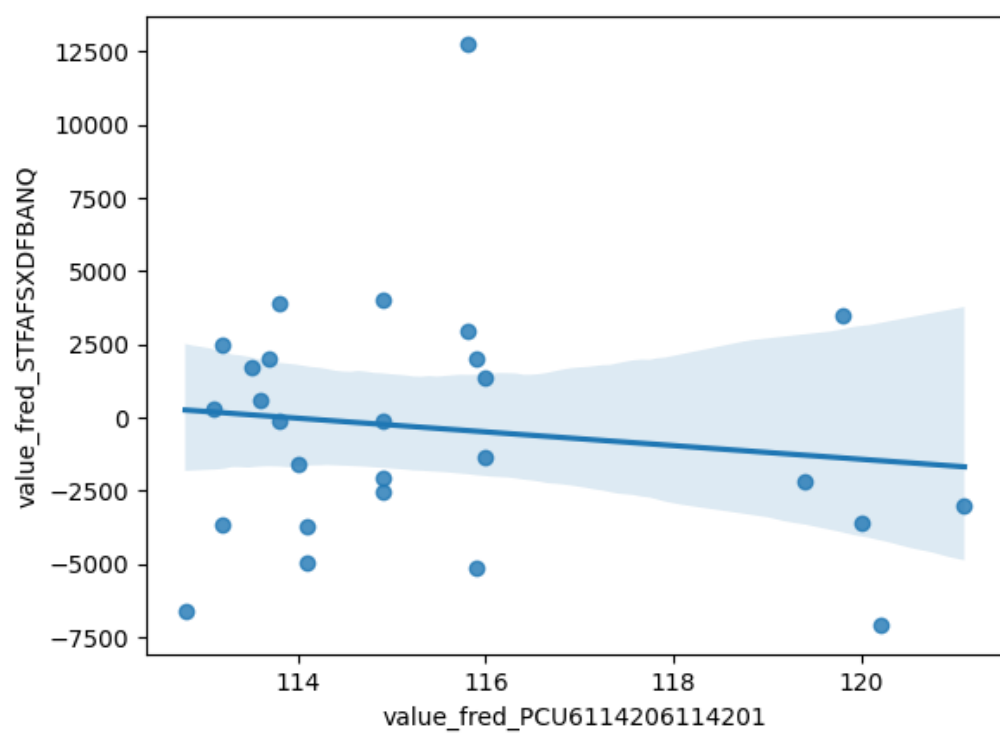


Figure 9: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-02

6.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_STFAFSXDFBANQ_detrended	R-squared:	0.123
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.088
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	3.501
Date:	Fri, 02 Oct 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0731
Time:	16:53:47	Log-Likelihood:	-260.81
No. Observations:	27	AIC:	525.6
Df Residuals:	25	BIC:	528.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.618e-08	758.492	-2.13e-11	1.000	-1562.143	1562.143
value_fred_PCU6114206114201_detrended	-1205.5548	644.324	-1.871	0.073	-2532.565	121.455

Omnibus:	3.116	Durbin-Watson:	1.754
Prob(Omnibus):	0.211	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.662
Skew:	0.522	Prob(JB):	0.436
Kurtosis:	3.624	Cond. No.	1.18

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

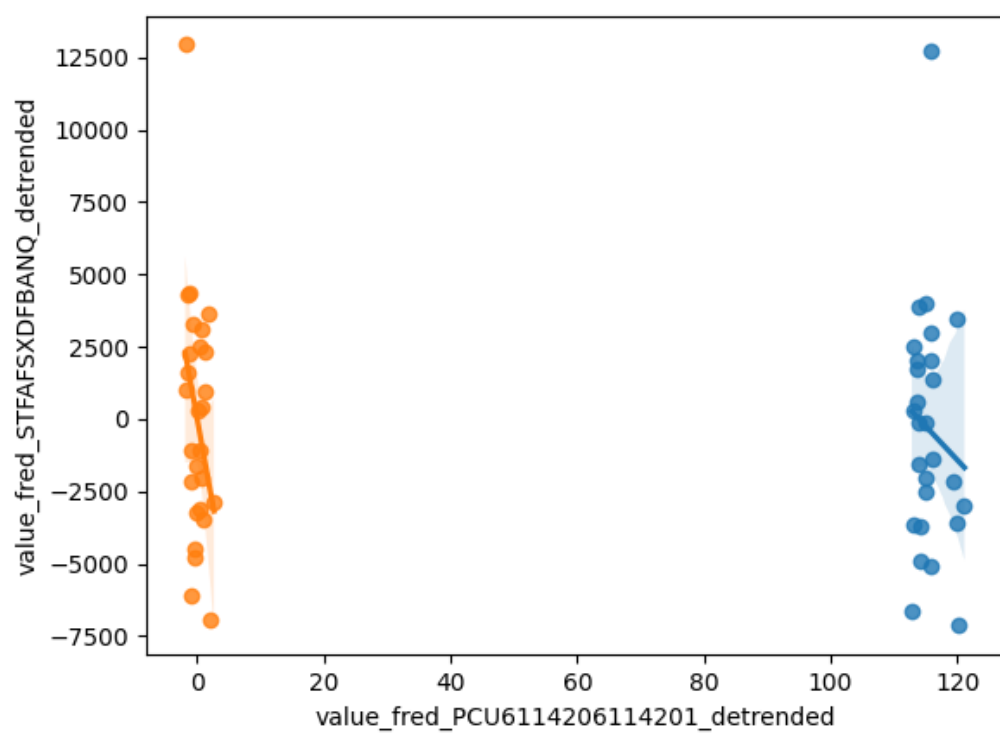


Figure 10: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-02